Seeing Through Photographs

Total Level: 12 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs
Welcome to Seeing Through Photographs! Reading • 3 min
Getting Started: Practice This Course Now! Reading • 3 min
Seeing Through Photographs Course Trailer Video • 1 min
Visit Moma: Introduce the Center Reading • 10 min
Course Reference on "Photography Changes Everything" Reading • 10 min
Optional Discussion Forum Prompts Reading • 10 min
Optional Reading and Resources Reading • 10 min

Module 2
Film, Budget, Many Perspectives

Module 3
Documentary and the Documentary

Module 4
One and another

Module 5
Candice Ong, Narratives, Challenging Validities

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Corpus of Images

Optional Readings and Resources

0:00 / 2:03

Below are **optional** readings and resources that provide additional context for the concepts and artworks featured in this course. Please note that these are **NOT required**; you can complete this course without reviewing them. You can also access everything in these after you complete the course.

Please consider supporting the Museum's mission by purchasing your favorite books at the MoMA Store. It's fun to shop for books at the MoMA Store and online features! Add the course as a gift item to your wishlist. Thank you for supporting MoMA!

Selected Excerpts of MoMA Publications

Quentin Bajac, "Contemporary Photography at MoMA," in The Photography of MoMA: 1920–Now, The Museum of Modern Art, 2015, 10–19.

Richard Benson, "Modern Photography," in The Printed Picture, The Museum of Modern Art, 2008, 144–51.

Peter Galassi, "Introduction," in Pioneers of Photography, 1840–1940, The Museum of Modern Art, 1992, 14–18. Read online or download as PDF.

Susan Sontag, "America, Seen through Photographs, Darkly," in Mindful Silent, People, Places, Things, The Museum of Modern Art, 1980, 193–208.

John Szarkowski, Introduction to The Photographer's Eye, in The Museum of Modern Art, 1966, 9–11. Purchase the full publication (PDF) at MoMA Store.

John Szarkowski, Looking at Photographs, in The Museum of Modern Art, 1973, 9–10. Purchase the full publication (PDF) at MoMA Store.

Additional online content

Book Activity sheet: Shape Stories, by artist Sarah Schmerler

Article Stephen Vincent, "Exhibition Review: Candice Breitz's Working Women," in Frieze

Blog MoMA Learning: Teaching Photography

Book Michael Kelly Williams, Everything Must Go: Vivian Maier's Unsold Negatives, 2017. The Wager Pictures, August 8, 2013. Screenwriter: Andrew Levitas.

Book Seeing Like a Photographer

Podcast Lens Shifter Series: Artists and Image Ownership, in The New York Times

Podcast Women Working Behind the Lens: The Legacy of Dorothy Wilson Caldwell 1900–1989

Characters

Candice Ong, Singaporean, b. 1982, Lives and works in Singapore

Lee Friedlander, American, b. 1934

Alec Soth, American, b. 1969

Ari Versluis & Wil Hagen, Dutch, Lives and works in Amsterdam, Netherlands

Stay connected to MoMA

Library Research Guides: Curated via produced by MoMA and MoMA Studios

Library Open Access: 2,000 work tools curated by MoMA and MoMA Studios

Library Learning Resources: Teaching Materials: 11 Interviews with Social Workers on the World by grade and by topics

Book MoMA Membership

Article Modern Art Museum Glossary

Podcast Artists Reading Photography and Literature

Podcast Women Who Photograph: An Introduction

Mark as completed

Like Reply Report an issue